Website: https://iq-hackathon.github.io/hackathon-beginners-26/

2026

Interstate Quantum Hackathon

FOR BEGINNERS



No prior quantum experience required.

WHEN

Oct 22–24, 2026

Kickoff: Oct 22, 5:00 PM ET
Closing ceremony: Oct 30

WHERE

Hybrid

At partner institutions and online via Zoom

WHO

Beginners welcome!
Undergraduate students
Graduate students
Working professionals

THE CHALLENGES

VQE for Chemistry & Materials

Q-algorithms for molecular and materials problems

Quantum Machine Learning

Build a quantum/classical model for real-world data problems.

Optimization for Energy & Grid

Q-algorithms to optimization problems for energy systems and the electric grid.

Pre-Hackathon Online Training | Industry Talk | Hands-on Qiskit | IBM Certificates of Participation MTSU badge | Awards, Food and Stipends

SCHEDULE · ALL TIMES ET

Sept 24 – Oct 4	**Registration open**
Oct 9, Oct 16 12pm-1:30pm	Online training sessions (Quantum basics, Qiskit, VQE, QML)
Oct 22 5pm-6:30pm	Launch & project selection,
Oct 23 5pm-6:30pm	Keynote industry talk
Oct 24 9am-4pm	Hacking, Project submission, presentations & judging

Registration link:

Registration open
Sept 24 – Oct 4, 2026

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ORGANIZING INSTITUTIONS

MTSU QRISE Center · Purdue University Fort Wayne · Meharry Medical College · Fisk University · Tennessee State University · University of West Florida · The University of Alabama in Huntsville · The University of Alabama · Missouri State University

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